

BANGALORE | Flying High

A FEUD IN THE GOVERNMENT COULD STALL SEVERAL HIGH-PROFILE REAL ESTATE PROJECTS IN CHANDIGARH.

The seventh edition of the biennial international air show Aero India 2009 at the Indian Air Force station at Yelahanka from February 11-15 2009 will include flight and static displays of nearly 100 fighter jets, maritime surveillance aircraft, unmanned aerial vehicles and giant Russian transport planes that can carry a few trucks inside. The Defence Ministry-led show, which took off in 1996 at the same venue, is billed as Asia's largest.

by Stephen David



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CHANDIGARH | Fight Club

The city is mired in an ugly spat between Punjab Governor General S.F. Rodrigues (retd)—who also wears the hat as the administrator of the Union Territory—and top bureaucrat Pradip Mehra. The latter has publicly opened a can of worms over alleged irregularities in a string of high-profile and mega projects endorsed by Rodrigues. The governor has hit back, ordering a vigilance probe against Mehra. The multi-crore projects include a mega Film City, a Medicity and an amusement-cum-theme park. by Ramesh Vinayak

Win-Win

The DMK's victory in the by-election for Thirumangalam hasn't really hurt the AIADMK. Jayalalithaa's party lost the seat but she is relieved that Vijayakanth's DMDK didn't play spoilsport in the bypoll, billed as a semifinal to the Lok Sabha elections. The DMDK candidate did not even stand second leaving Vijayakanth out of Jayalalithaa's way in her battle with M. Karunanidhi, even though her third front ambitions may have been shaken.

by S. Senthil Kumar

DELHI | Look Far East

The Tourism Ministry's South East Asia campaign seems to be paying off. From 2006 to 2007, tourists to India from China grew 41.3 per cent, from Japan 22 per cent, from South Korea 21 per cent and from Singapore 12.5 per cent. To create an India buzz in Japan, the Ministry of Tourism launched its Incredible India campaign with ten Velo taxis carrying images of India with the drivers wearing Rajasthani turbans in Tokyo (right). Similar campaigns have been launched in other Asian nations. "The Far East is becoming an increasingly important market for us," says Leena Nandan, joint secretary, Ministry of Tourism. By Nandini Vaish



VELO TAXIS IN TOKYO